



1. Zero-Shot Prompting

Ask the AI directly without giving examples. Best for quick summaries or simple Q&A.

Simple Q&A

Basic Summaries

Quick Drafts

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Summarize this complaint.

[AFTER]

Summarize this banking complaint in 5 bullets:

1. Issue
2. Customer impact
3. Urgency
4. Missing information
5. Next action

Complaint: Customer says RM 2,500 was debited but beneficiary did not receive it.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Explain AI in banking.

[AFTER]

Explain AI in banking operations in simple language for branch staff. Use 3 examples: complaint summary, report summary, and policy search. Mention one risk.

Banking use: Fast first drafts, simple summaries, quick explanations.



2. Few-Shot Prompting

Give a few examples so the AI follows the same pattern and format.

Classification

Specific Format

Consistency

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Classify this complaint.

[AFTER]

Use this pattern:

Example 1: ATM cash not dispensed -> Category: ATM Issue | Urgency: High

Example 2: Unable to login -> Category: Digital Banking | Urgency: Medium

Now classify: EMI deducted twice this month.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Find sentiment.

[AFTER]

Examples:

'I am happy with quick service' -> Positive

'I called 3 times and no update' -> Negative

'Please check my pending request' -> Neutral

Now classify: 'My money is debited and nobody is helping.'

Banking use: Complaint classification, sentiment tagging, issue routing.



3. Role Prompting

Tell the AI which banking role or expert viewpoint to use.

Expert Persona

Compliance Review

Operations View

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Review this message.

[AFTER]

Act as a banking compliance reviewer.
Review this customer email draft for:

- Privacy risk
- Unsupported promise
- Policy gap
- Tone issue

Then provide a safer rewritten version.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Analyze this report.

[AFTER]

Act as a branch operations manager. Review this daily MIS report and identify operational highlights, customer impact, risks, and actions for tomorrow.

Banking use: Compliance review, operations review, customer support drafting.



4. Style Prompting

Control the writing style: formal, simple, empathetic, executive, or SMS-like.

Tone Control

Customer Emails

Executive Style

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Write a reply to the customer.

[AFTER]

Rewrite this response in a polite, empathetic, and professional banking tone.
Keep it under 120 words.
Do not promise refund before verification.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Summarize branch performance.

[AFTER]

Write an executive-style summary for senior management. Use formal tone, short paragraphs, and focus on risks, exceptions, and decisions needed.

Banking use: Customer emails, branch notices, executive summaries.



5. Emotion Prompting

Ask for the right emotional tone while keeping the facts unchanged.

Empathy

Customer Trust

Complaint Handling

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Tell the customer to wait.

[AFTER]

Draft an empathetic response to a customer whose ATM withdrawal failed but account was debited. Acknowledge concern, explain verification is needed, share next step, and avoid blaming the customer.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Reject the request.

[AFTER]

Politely inform the customer that the request cannot be completed until KYC documents are verified. Sound respectful, calm, and helpful.

Banking use: Difficult complaints, delayed cases, customer trust-building.



6. Contextual Prompting

Give background details so the AI does not guess or give a generic answer.

Background

Constraints

Better Accuracy

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Suggest action for this complaint.

[AFTER]

Context:

- Complaint raised 3 days ago
- Amount: RM 2,500
- Channel: mobile banking
- Status: pending verification

Suggest next action, customer update, and internal escalation note.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Summarize this customer issue.

[AFTER]

Context: This is a priority banking customer. Issue: duplicate EMI debit. Previous complaint exists. Draft a case summary, missing details, and escalation note.

Banking use: Complaint history, policy context, branch reports.



7. Step-by-Step Prompting

Ask the AI to follow a short checklist so important points are not missed.

Checklist

Risk Review

Accuracy

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Analyze this fraud alert.

[AFTER]

Review this fraud alert using this checklist:

1. Alert type
2. Customer impact
3. Evidence to verify
4. Escalation need
5. Final human decision required

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Check this KYC case.

[AFTER]

Review this KYC case step by step:

1. Identity proof
2. Address proof
3. Name match
4. Risk category
5. Missing documents
6. Supervisor review needed

Banking use: Fraud alerts, KYC checks, failed transaction reviews.



8. System Prompting

Set standing rules or guardrails that apply throughout the task.

Guardrails

Safety Rules

Consistency

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Summarize complaints.

[AFTER]

System rule:
Use only sample data. Never include real customer identifiers. If information is missing, say 'Not provided'. Mark all decisions requiring human approval.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Answer from the policy.

[AFTER]

System rule:
Answer only from the uploaded policy. If the answer is not found, say 'Not available in the provided document'. Do not guess.

Banking use: Document Q&A, classroom assistants, repeated tasks.



9. Explicit Instructions

Be direct about format, length, content, restrictions, and output fields.

Strict Format

No Ambiguity

Clear Output

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Write about failed payments.

[AFTER]

Create exactly 6 bullets:

1. Issue summary
 2. Affected channel
 3. Customer impact
 4. Risk level
 5. Next action
 6. Human review needed
- Do not exceed 100 words.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Summarize this report.

[AFTER]

Output only in this table format:
Metric | Observation | Risk | Action
Do not add paragraphs. Use only the data provided.

Banking use: Reports, checklists, handover notes, audit summaries.



10. Output Priming

Start the answer structure so the AI continues in the desired format.

Template

Lists

Form-Like Output

Example 1

[BEFORE]

What should I do?

[AFTER]

Continue this template for the complaint:
Issue Summary: ...
Category: ...
Urgency: ...
Missing Information: ...
Next Action: ...
Human Review: ...

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Create a branch report.

[AFTER]

Complete the report using this structure:
Executive Summary:
Top 3 Exceptions:
Customer Impact:
Action Required:
Manager Approval Needed:

Banking use: Consistent response formats and form-like outputs.



11. Rephrase and Respond

Ask the AI to first restate its understanding, then answer.

Ambiguous Requests

High-Stakes Tasks

Confirmation

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Reply to this customer.

[AFTER]

First rephrase the customer issue in one sentence.
Then draft a response.
If important information is missing, list it before writing the response.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Resolve this complaint.

[AFTER]

First restate what the complaint appears to be. Then list missing details. Then suggest the next internal action. Do not claim the complaint is resolved.

Banking use: Unclear customer requests and high-risk communication.



12. Step-Back Prompting

Ask for the broader principle first, then answer the specific question.

Policy Reasoning

Privacy

First Principles

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Can we send PAN on WhatsApp?

[AFTER]

First explain the general banking data privacy principle for customer identifiers.
Then answer whether PAN/account details should be sent on WhatsApp.
Include the safer alternative.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Should we approve this loan?

[AFTER]

First explain the general principle of responsible AI in loan support. Then explain what information a human loan officer must verify before any decision.

Banking use: Privacy, compliance, policy interpretation, risk discussions.



13. Self-Critique & Refinement

Ask the AI to draft, check against criteria, and improve the output.

Review

Refine

Quality

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Draft a customer response.

[AFTER]

Draft a response.
Then review it for:

- Privacy risk
- Unsupported promise
- Unclear next action
- Tone
- Compliance concern

Finally provide an improved version.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Create a fraud summary.

[AFTER]

Create a fraud alert summary. Then critique it for missing evidence, assumptions, unclear risk, and overconfident wording. Provide a safer final version.

Banking use: Customer communication and compliance-sensitive drafts.



14. Goal Decomposition

Break a large task into smaller, manageable steps.

Workflows

Process Design

Multi-Step Tasks

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Create a complaint process.

[AFTER]

Build a complaint handling workflow in stages:

1. Intake
2. Classification
3. Verification
4. Escalation
5. Response drafting
6. Human approval
7. Closure and audit record

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Make a KYC workflow.

[AFTER]

Break KYC review into steps: document collection, identity check, address check, risk check, missing items, maker-checker review, compliance approval.

Banking use: Workflow automation, SOP creation, process mapping.



15. Meta-Prompting

Ask the AI to write a better prompt for your task.

Prompt Design

Blank Page Help

Optimization

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Help me write a prompt.

[AFTER]

Create a strong prompt for summarizing a branch MIS report. Include role, task, input data, output format, constraints, and human review instruction.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Make my prompt better.

[AFTER]

Improve this prompt for banking use. Add role, context, output format, privacy rule, and human approval rule:
'Summarize this customer issue.'

Banking use: Prompt design support when participants do not know how to start.



16. ReAct (Reason + Act)

Use a structured cycle: identify need, check source, answer, and review.

Verification

Document Q&A

Source Checking

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Answer from this policy.

[AFTER]

Use this process:

Need: identify the policy question.

Check: use only the uploaded document.

Answer: provide the answer.

Review: mention what a human should verify.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Find escalation steps.

[AFTER]

Process:

Question: what escalation is needed?

Source check: find it in the SOP.

Answer: give steps.

Control: say what the supervisor must verify.

Banking use: Policy search, document Q&A, evidence-based answers.



17. Thread-of-Thought

Keep a connected structure across a long task or multiple prompts.

Long Tasks

Consistency

Training Design

Example 1

[BEFORE]

Create training plan.

[AFTER]

Maintain one consistent thread for every module:
Objective -> Audience -> Banking scenario -> Prompt -> Demo ->
Activity -> Risk control -> Participant takeaway.

Example 2

[BEFORE]

Create a long SOP.

[AFTER]

Write the SOP with one connected flow:
Purpose -> Scope -> Inputs -> Steps -> Exceptions -> Approvals ->
Customer communication -> Audit record.

Banking use: Long reports, SOPs, training design, multi-step projects.